



VantageScore Guide

Understanding VantageScore 4.0 and its role in mortgage credit reporting.

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VantageScore is a credit scoring model used to help lenders evaluate a borrower's credit profile. Like other credit scores, it is designed to estimate credit risk based on the information found in a borrower's credit report.

VantageScore uses a score range of 300 to 850, with higher scores generally indicating stronger credit.

What Is VantageScore 4.0?

VantageScore 4.0 is a modern version of the VantageScore model that uses current credit data and scoring methods. One of its notable features is the use of trended credit data, which considers how a borrower has managed credit over time — not just a point-in-time snapshot.

This may provide a broader view of certain borrowers' credit behavior — particularly those with limited credit history or improving credit profiles.

VantageScore 4.0 has been approved for use in the modernized mortgage credit score framework, but lender, investor, AUS, and implementation requirements may vary.

How VantageScore 4.0 Differs from Classic FICO Mortgage Scores

VantageScore 4.0 and Classic FICO mortgage scores are different scoring models. They use different methods to assess credit risk and may produce different results for the same borrower.

Scoring Model	Score Range	Key Feature
VantageScore 4.0	300–850	Uses trended credit data — considers credit behavior over time, not just a snapshot
Classic FICO Mortgage Scores	300–850	Widely used in mortgage underwriting; required by many lenders, investors, and AUS platforms

■ A VantageScore Should Not Be Assumed to Match a Classic FICO Mortgage Score

VantageScore 4.0 and Classic FICO mortgage scores are separate models and should not be treated as interchangeable. The scores may differ even for the same borrower.

Lender, Investor, and AUS Acceptance

VantageScore 4.0 is gaining broader recognition in the mortgage industry. However, acceptance and usage vary by lender, investor, AUS, and applicable guidelines.

- Some lenders may continue to rely primarily on Classic FICO mortgage scores for qualification.
- Some lenders may use VantageScore as a supplemental tool rather than a primary qualifying score.
- Lenders may apply their own overlays, adjustments, or internal policies when working with VantageScore.
- AUS requirements (DU and LPA) may differ from individual lender policies.

■ Always Confirm Which Scoring Model Your Lender Requires

Clients should verify with their lender, investor, and AUS which scoring model is being used for qualification before relying on a VantageScore result for lending decisions. ISC Credit does not make underwriting decisions and cannot confirm lender or investor requirements.

3 Key Takeaway

A VantageScore should not be assumed to match a Classic FICO mortgage score. Always confirm which scoring model your lender, investor, or AUS requires.

Questions about which score model applies to your workflow? Contact ISC Credit at (800) 290-2801 and confirm requirements with your lender, investor, or AUS provider.

This guide is for general workflow education only. Requirements may vary by lender, investor, AUS, credit bureau, account setup, and applicable law. ISC Credit does not make underwriting or credit approval decisions. Clients should follow their own company policies, investor guidelines, and compliance requirements.